

A TEACHING FROM KINGDOM LIFE MINISTRY

The Marriage Covenant

Why Yahshua Had to Die to Get His Bride Back

Sinai was a wedding. The bride was unfaithful.
She was lawfully divorced, and His own instruction
barred her return. This is how He kept His word
without breaking a single letter of it.

All Scripture from the World English Bible
Companion teaching: *Who You Are*

KINGDOM LIFE MINISTRY

Walk in truth, walk in light.

A Few Words Explained

If some of this is new to you, these four will carry you through the whole teaching.

YHWH is the actual name of the Creator as it appears in the Hebrew Scriptures. Most Bibles replace it with the title "the LORD" in capital letters. We use His name.

Yahshua is the Hebrew name of the Messiah, the name most people know as Jesus.

Torah means "instructions." It is the first five books of the Bible. Think of it less as a rule book and more as terms and guidance given by a Husband to His bride. That will matter a great deal in a moment.

The two houses. After King Solomon died, the nation of Israel split in two. The northern kingdom kept the name Israel, sometimes called Ephraim or Joseph. The southern kingdom was called Judah, where we get the word "Jew." This split is not a small detail. It is the key to the whole story.

Sinai Was a Wedding

When YHWH brought Israel out of Egypt and met them at Mount Sinai, He was not simply handing down a legal code. He was proposing marriage. Read the scene with that in mind and it changes completely.

He makes the proposal:

Exodus 19:4-5

"You have seen what I did to the Egyptians, and how I bore you on eagles' wings, and brought you to myself. Now therefore, if you will indeed obey my voice and keep my covenant, then you shall be my own possession from among all peoples."

The bride answers:

Exodus 19:8

"All the people answered together, and said, 'All that YHWH has spoken we will do.'"

That is the "I do."

Then she prepares herself. She washes her garments and waits three days, which is the bridal immersion.

Exodus 19:10-11

"Go to the people, and sanctify them today and tomorrow, and let them wash their garments, and be ready for the third day."

Then the covenant is sealed in blood, the way covenants were:

Exodus 24:8

"Moses took the blood, and sprinkled it on the people, and said, 'Look, this is the blood of the covenant, which YHWH has made with you concerning all these words.'"

And if there is any doubt about what just happened, YHWH says it Himself, plainly, centuries later:

Jeremiah 31:32

"...which my covenant they broke, although I was a husband to them," says YHWH.

He says it again through Ezekiel, in language no one can mistake:

Ezekiel 16:8

"Yes, I swore to you, and entered into a covenant with you," says the Lord YHWH, "and you became mine."

THE POINT

The Torah is the marriage contract. The instructions are the terms of the covenant a Husband gave to His wife.

The Bride Was Unfaithful

The northern kingdom, Israel, turned to other gods. Scripture does not describe this as a policy failure or a religious mistake. It calls it adultery, because that is exactly what it is when a wife gives herself to another.

Jeremiah 3:8

"...backsliding Israel had committed adultery..."

PART THREE

He Gave Her a Certificate of Divorce

This is the part most people have never been taught, and it changes everything:

Jeremiah 3:8

"I saw, when, for this very cause that backsliding Israel had committed adultery, I had put her away and given her a bill of divorce, yet treacherous Judah her sister didn't fear; but she also went and played the prostitute."

Notice carefully who received the certificate. Israel, the northern house, was divorced. Judah was not. Judah watched it happen and did not learn from it, but Judah remained in covenant.

That single verse is the reason the two houses have had two different histories ever since. Judah kept the name, the identity, the Scriptures. Israel was scattered into the nations and lost all of it.

Hosea 1:9

"Call his name Lo-Ammi; for you are not my people, and I will not be yours."

Lo-Ammi means "not my people." The divorced wife was sent out, absorbed into the nations, and forgot who she was.

PART FOUR

Then Comes an Impossible Problem

Here is where it becomes remarkable.

YHWH promises to take her back:

Hosea 2:19

"I will betroth you to me forever. Yes, I will betroth you to me in righteousness, in justice, in loving kindness, and in compassion."

But His own instruction forbids it. In the covenant terms He Himself gave, a man may not remarry the wife he divorced once she has been joined to another man:

Deuteronomy 24:4

"...her former husband, who sent her away, may not take her again to be his wife, after that she is defiled; for that is abomination before YHWH."

And she had been joined to another. She went after other gods. That is the whole reason she was sent away.

Now read this verse slowly, because YHWH raises the exact objection Himself:

Jeremiah 3:1

"They say, 'If a man puts away his wife, and she goes from him, and become another man's, should he return to her again?' Wouldn't that land be greatly polluted? But you have played the prostitute with many lovers; yet return again to me," says YHWH.

He names the legal obstacle, then says come back anyway.

So He has bound Himself two ways at once. He swore to take her back. His own righteous instruction says He cannot. And He does not break His word:

Psalms 89:34

"I will not break my covenant, nor alter what my lips have uttered."

Malachi 3:6

"For I, YHWH, don't change."

HOLD THIS TENSION

This is not a loophole to be found. It is a genuine problem, and there is only one thing in all of Scripture that resolves it.

PART FIVE

The Husband Has to Die

There is exactly one event that releases a wife from her marriage covenant, and it is not divorce. It is death.

Romans 7:2

"For the woman that has a husband is bound by law to the husband while he lives, but if the husband dies, she is discharged from the law of the husband."

Paul is not making a side comment about marriage here. He is making this exact argument, and he says where it lands:

Romans 7:4

"Therefore, my brothers, you also were made dead to the law through the body of Messiah, that you would be joined to another, to him who was raised from the dead, that we might produce fruit to Elohim."

Joined to another. To Him who was raised from the dead.

The Husband died. Death ends the covenant, and when the covenant ends, the barrier of Deuteronomy 24 ends with it. She is no longer a divorced woman who cannot return. She is a widow, and a widow is free to marry.

Hebrews 9:16-17

"For where a last will and testament is, there must of necessity be the death of him who made it. For a will is in force where there has been death."

And here is the piece that ties it together. The Husband was YHWH Himself. No one else's death could have done it, because no one else was the Husband. So He came in the flesh as Yahshua, and He died.

Then He rose, no longer bound by the former covenant, free to betroth her again without violating one word of His own instruction.

2 Corinthians 11:2

"For I married you to one husband, that I might present you as a pure virgin to Messiah."

THE WHOLE TEACHING IN ONE SENTENCE

The cross was not YHWH setting aside His own standard to make an exception. It was YHWH satisfying His own standard completely, at the cost of His own life, so He could keep His promise.

PART SIX

The Two Sticks Become One

Now the prophecy in Ezekiel makes sense.

Ezekiel 37:19

"...I will take the stick of Joseph, which is in the hand of Ephraim, and the tribes of Israel his companions; and I will put them with it, with the stick of Judah, and make them one stick, and they shall be one in my hand."

Ezekiel 37:22

"...they shall be no more two nations, neither shall they be divided into two kingdoms any more at all."

Two sticks. Two houses. One divorced, one not. The resurrection is the legal act that makes their reunion possible, because the divorced one could not come home until the Husband died.

Watch who the renewed covenant is made with:

Jeremiah 31:31

"Behold, the days come," says YHWH, "that I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel, and with the house of Judah."

Both houses. Named separately. Because only one of them needed the legal remedy, but both are brought into the same covenant.

And the ones who were called "not my people" get their identity back:

Hosea 1:10-11

"...in the place where it was said to them, 'You are not my people,' they will be called 'sons of the living El.' Then the children of Judah and the children of Israel will be gathered together."

Paul says the same thing to people out in the nations:

Ephesians 2:12-13

"...you were at that time separate from Messiah, alienated from the commonwealth of Israel, and strangers from the covenants of the promise... But now in Messiah Yahshua you who once were far off are made near in the blood of Messiah."

Read that again. Not brought in as strangers. Brought near, back to a commonwealth they were alienated from. You cannot be alienated from something you never belonged to.

PART SEVEN

What This Means for You

If you have ever felt like you were too far gone, that you had disqualified yourself, that whatever you did put you permanently outside of what YHWH would receive... this is your story.

She was unfaithful. She was legally divorced. She had gone to another. By the letter of the covenant she could never come home.

And He died to bring her back.

That is not YHWH lowering His standard for you. That is YHWH paying the full price of His own standard so that He could keep you.

Isaiah 54:5

"For your Maker is your husband; YHWH of Armies is his name."

And it ends where every wedding ends:

Revelation 19:7

"Let us rejoice and be exceedingly glad, and let us give the glory to him. For the wedding of the Lamb has come, and his wife has made herself ready."

QUESTIONS

Questions People Ask

"If His death freed her from the covenant, wouldn't that just leave her free, not remarried to Him?"

Yes, and that is exactly the point. She had to be freed first. As a divorced woman who had gone to another, she was permanently barred from returning. As a widow, she is free to marry anyone, including the One who rose. The death removed the barrier. The resurrection provided the Husband.

"Was Judah divorced too?"

No. Isaiah 50:1 asks, "Where is the bill of your mother's divorce?" and the answer is that there isn't one. That question is spoken to Zion, to Judah. Judah was never given a certificate. Only the northern house was, which is exactly why the two houses have to be brought back together.

"Did YHWH die?"

Yahshua is YHWH come in the flesh. He laid down His life and took it up again. This is why He and no one else could resolve it. Any other death would have been the death of someone who was not the Husband, and it would have changed nothing.

"So does this mean the instructions were cancelled?"

No. The opposite. The whole reason He had to die is that He would not set aside a single word of His own instruction. If the instructions could simply be waived, there would have been no need for a cross at all.

REFERENCE

All Verses in This Teaching

THE WEDDING AT SINAI

Exodus 19:4-8; Exodus 19:10-11; Exodus 24:3-8; Jeremiah 31:32; Ezekiel 16:8

THE UNFAITHFULNESS AND THE DIVORCE

Jeremiah 3:6-10; Hosea 1:6-9; 2 Kings 17:6-23

THE LEGAL PROBLEM

Jeremiah 3:1; Deuteronomy 24:1-4; Hosea 2:19-20; Psalm 89:34; Malachi 3:6

THE DEATH OF THE HUSBAND

Romans 7:1-4; Hebrews 9:15-17; 2 Corinthians 11:2

THE TWO STICKS

Ezekiel 37:15-28; Jeremiah 31:31-34; Hosea 1:10-11; Ephesians 2:11-19; Romans 11:17-24

THE WEDDING TO COME

Isaiah 54:5; Revelation 19:7-9

Walk in truth, walk in light. Shalom.

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